

RF and Microwave Engineering Exam Notes

EX 716 (BEI) / EX 752 (BEX) · IV-I / IV-II · TU, IOE · tiers over 24 papers, 2069–2082 BS

4. RF/Microwave Components and Devices

8 hrs · asked in **all 24 papers** · 11 syllabus sub-topics · **317 marks, 16.7% of the archive, 52 questions** → one derivation (the waveguide) worth up to 10 marks, one device (the magic tee) asked 9 times, and a ring of 4 to 6 mark short notes.

READ THIS FIRST

Chapter 4 has the biggest question count in the paper, but three scripts answer most of it:

- Field equations of a rectangular waveguide, TE or TM** (14 papers, up to **10 marks**) → §4.1. **One six-step script covers both modes**: only the boundary condition in step 4 changes. Learn TM first; TE is the same page with sin and cos swapped.
- Mode questions** (9 papers, 1 to 5 marks each): dominant, degenerate, “prove TM_{01} cannot exist”, “show TM_{11} is the lowest TM mode” → §4.2. Every one is **the cut-off formula plus one sentence**.
- Magic tee** (9 papers) → §4.5 for construction and the derivation, §3.6 for the matrix. The combinations (two tees joined, arms terminated) are worked in the numerical companion.

Two more things worth knowing before the paper starts:

- Circular waveguide** (4 papers, 7 to 10 marks) is the rectangular script again in cylindrical coordinates, with Bessel functions in place of sines. The only new fact to memorise is the **root table** of §4.3.
- Short notes** rotate among circulator (3 papers), directional coupler (3), cavity resonator (2), Gunn diode, MASER, probe/loop coupling and microstrip (1 each). Each gets a ready answer below.

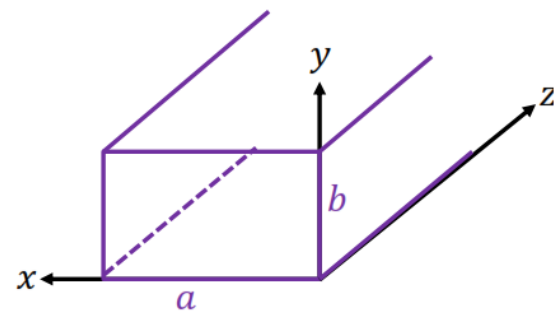
4.1 Rectangular Waveguide: TE and TM Field Equations

Derive the field equations and characteristic parameters of a rectangular waveguide operating in TE / TM mode **4 5 7+3 8 8+2 10**

TOP 14/24 69 Bh, 70 Bh, 70 Ma, 71 Bh, 72 Ma, 74 Ma, 74 Bh, 76 Bh, 77 Ch, 79 Ch, 80 Ch, 80 Bh, 81 Ba, 81 Bh · **the most repeated ask in the chapter: TE 6 papers, TM 7, modes in general 1**

Set-up

- Hollow metal pipe, inner broad wall a along x , narrow wall b along y , propagation along $+z$, $a > b$.
- Lossless dielectric (μ, ϵ) inside, perfectly conducting walls.
- Every field component carries $e^{-\gamma z}$, $\gamma = \alpha + j\beta$.
- Notation used throughout (Gangaju):
 - $k = \omega\sqrt{\mu\epsilon}$, the free-space wave number of the filling.
 - $h^2 = \gamma^2 + k^2 = k_x^2 + k_y^2$, the cut-off wave number squared (Pozar writes k_c^2).
- No TEM mode.** With $E_z = H_z = 0$ every transverse component below is zero. Physically, a closed H loop in the cross-section needs an axial current, and a single hollow conductor has no centre conductor to carry it.



Co-ordinates of the rectangular guide. Source: Gangaju, Ch-4 deck, slide 12.

Step 1: transverse fields from the longitudinal ones (Maxwell's curl equations)

- Write $\nabla \times E = -j\omega\mu H$ and $\nabla \times H = j\omega\epsilon E$ in components with $\partial/\partial z \rightarrow -\gamma$, and solve the four transverse equations for E_x, E_y, H_x, H_y :

$$E_x = -\frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial x} - \frac{j\omega\mu}{h^2} \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial y}, \quad E_y = -\frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial y} + \frac{j\omega\mu}{h^2} \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial x},$$

$$H_x = -\frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial x} + \frac{j\omega\epsilon}{h^2} \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial y}, \quad H_y = -\frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial y} - \frac{j\omega\epsilon}{h^2} \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial x}.$$

- **This block is the whole trick:** find E_z (TM) or H_z (TE) and the other four components follow by differentiation.

Step 2: the wave equation for the longitudinal component

- Helmholtz: $\nabla^2 E_z + k^2 E_z = 0$, i.e. $\frac{\partial^2 E_z}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 E_z}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 E_z}{\partial z^2} + \omega^2 \mu \epsilon E_z = 0$.
- The same equation holds for H_z .

Step 3: separation of variables

- Put $E_z = X(x)Y(y)Z(z)$ and divide by XYZ : $\frac{X''}{X} + \frac{Y''}{Y} + \frac{Z''}{Z} = -k^2$.
- Each ratio must be a constant:
 - $X''/X = -k_x^2 \Rightarrow X = C_1 \cos k_x x + C_2 \sin k_x x$.
 - $Y''/Y = -k_y^2 \Rightarrow Y = C_3 \cos k_y y + C_4 \sin k_y y$.
 - $Z''/Z = \gamma^2 \Rightarrow Z = C_5 e^{\gamma z} + C_6 e^{-\gamma z}$; a wave along $+z$ only $\Rightarrow C_5 = 0$.
- Adding the constants back: $-k_x^2 - k_y^2 + \gamma^2 = -k^2$, so $\boxed{h^2 = k_x^2 + k_y^2 = \gamma^2 + k^2}$.
- General solution: $E_z = (A_1 \cos k_x x + A_2 \sin k_x x)(A_3 \cos k_y y + A_4 \sin k_y y) e^{-\gamma z}$.
- H_z has the same form with its own constants B_1, B_2, B_3, B_4 ; the working below reuses the letters A for brevity.

Step 4 (TM): $H_z = 0$, apply $E_z = 0$ on the walls

- E_z is tangential to every wall, so it must vanish there.
- $x = 0$: $E_z = 0 \Rightarrow A_1 = 0$.
- $y = 0$: $E_z = 0 \Rightarrow A_3 = 0$.
- $x = a$: $\sin k_x a = 0 \Rightarrow k_x = m\pi/a$.
- $y = b$: $\sin k_y b = 0 \Rightarrow k_y = n\pi/b$.

$$E_z = E_0 \sin \frac{m\pi x}{a} \sin \frac{n\pi y}{b} e^{-\gamma z}$$

Step 4 (TE): $E_z = 0$, apply $E_x, E_y = 0$ on the walls

- With $E_z = 0$: $E_x \propto \partial H_z / \partial y$, $E_y \propto \partial H_z / \partial x$.
- $x = 0$: $E_y = 0 \Rightarrow \partial H_z / \partial x = 0 \Rightarrow A_2 = 0$.
- $y = 0$: $E_x = 0 \Rightarrow \partial H_z / \partial y = 0 \Rightarrow A_4 = 0$.
- $x = a$: $\sin k_x a = 0 \Rightarrow k_x = m\pi/a$.
- $y = b$: $\sin k_y b = 0 \Rightarrow k_y = n\pi/b$.

$$H_z = H_0 \cos \frac{m\pi x}{a} \cos \frac{n\pi y}{b} e^{-\gamma z}$$

Deck slide 18 prints $k_y = n\pi/a$ in the last line; it is $n\pi/b$.

Step 5: substitute into Step 1 (write $e^{-\gamma z}$ on every line in the exam)

TM_{mn} ($H_z = 0$)

$$\begin{aligned} E_x &= -\frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{m\pi}{a} E_0 \cos \frac{m\pi x}{a} \sin \frac{n\pi y}{b} \\ E_y &= -\frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{n\pi}{b} E_0 \sin \frac{m\pi x}{a} \cos \frac{n\pi y}{b} \\ H_x &= \frac{j\omega\epsilon}{h^2} \frac{n\pi}{b} E_0 \sin \frac{m\pi x}{a} \cos \frac{n\pi y}{b} \\ H_y &= -\frac{j\omega\epsilon}{h^2} \frac{m\pi}{a} E_0 \cos \frac{m\pi x}{a} \sin \frac{n\pi y}{b} \end{aligned}$$

TE_{mn} ($E_z = 0$)

$$\begin{aligned} E_x &= \frac{j\omega\mu}{h^2} \frac{n\pi}{b} H_0 \cos \frac{m\pi x}{a} \sin \frac{n\pi y}{b} \\ E_y &= -\frac{j\omega\mu}{h^2} \frac{m\pi}{a} H_0 \sin \frac{m\pi x}{a} \cos \frac{n\pi y}{b} \\ H_x &= \frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{m\pi}{a} H_0 \sin \frac{m\pi x}{a} \cos \frac{n\pi y}{b} \\ H_y &= \frac{\gamma}{h^2} \frac{n\pi}{b} H_0 \cos \frac{m\pi x}{a} \sin \frac{n\pi y}{b} \end{aligned}$$

All eight components are checked in `src/wg.py` against both curl equations and against tangential $E = 0$ on all four walls; a single flipped sign fails the check.

Step 6: the characteristic equations (the “+2” or “+3” of every version)

Quantity	Expression	Note
Propagation constant	$\gamma = \sqrt{h^2 - k^2} = \sqrt{\left(\frac{m\pi}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n\pi}{b}\right)^2 - \omega^2\mu\epsilon}$	real below cut-off, imaginary above
Cut-off frequency	$f_c = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{\mu\epsilon}} \sqrt{\left(\frac{m}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n}{b}\right)^2}$	set $\gamma = 0$; air: $\frac{c}{2}\sqrt{\cdot}$
Cut-off wavelength	$\lambda_c = \frac{2}{\sqrt{(m/a)^2 + (n/b)^2}}$	TE ₁₀ : $\lambda_c = 2a$
Phase constant	$\beta = \omega\sqrt{\mu\epsilon}\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}$	above cut-off
Guide wavelength	$\lambda_g = \frac{\lambda}{\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}}$	$\frac{1}{\lambda^2} = \frac{1}{\lambda_g^2} + \frac{1}{\lambda_c^2}$
Phase velocity	$v_p = \frac{\beta}{\omega} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}}$	$> v$, carries no energy
Group velocity	$v_g = \frac{d\omega}{d\beta} = v\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}$	$< v$; $v_p v_g = v^2$
Wave impedance, TE	$Z_{TE} = \frac{E_x}{H_y} = -\frac{E_y}{H_x} = \frac{\omega\mu}{\beta} = \eta \frac{\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}}{\sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}}$	$> \eta$
Wave impedance, TM	$Z_{TM} = \frac{E_x}{H_y} = -\frac{E_y}{H_x} = \frac{\beta}{\omega\epsilon} = \eta \sqrt{1 - (f_c/f)^2}$	$< \eta$

- Three regimes from $\gamma^2 = h^2 - \omega^2\mu\epsilon$:
 - $f < f_c$: $\gamma = \alpha$, real → **evanescent**, the field decays and carries no power. A waveguide is a **high-pass filter**.
 - $f = f_c$: $\gamma = 0$, cut-off.
 - $f > f_c$: $\gamma = j\beta$ → **propagates**.
- $v = 1/\sqrt{\mu\epsilon}$, $\eta = \sqrt{\mu/\epsilon}$; for air $v = c$ and $\eta_0 = 120\pi \approx 377\ \Omega$.

Answer skeleton for the 4 to 5 mark short-note version 4 5

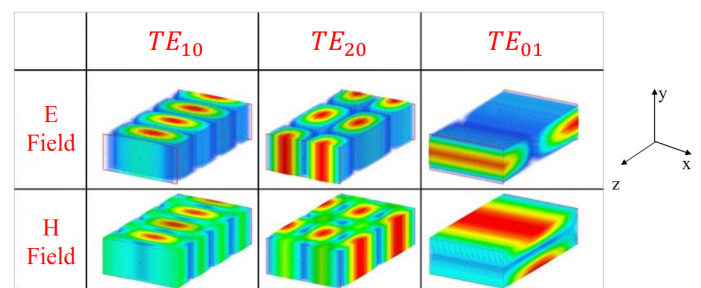
- Figure of the guide with a, b, z (1 line).
- Step 1 block, then the one boundary-condition result ($E_z = E_0 \sin \sin$ for TM, $H_z = H_0 \cos \cos$ for TE).
- The four transverse components from Step 5, without re-deriving them.
- f_c and one of Z_{TE} / Z_{TM} . For the 10-mark version add Steps 2 to 4 in full and the whole Step 6 table.

4.2 Modes: Dominant, Degenerate, and the Short Proofs**Dominant and degenerate modes; show which modes cannot exist; compare modes by cut-off** 1+1+2

2 2+2 3 5

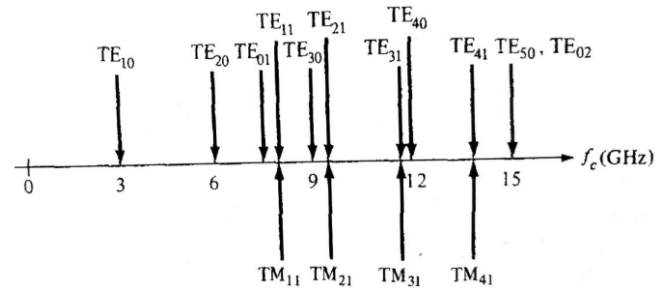
TOP 9/24 70 Bh, 70 Ma, 71 Bh, 72 Ma, 72 Ash, 80 Bh, 81 Bh, 82 Ba, 82 Bh · every one is the f_c formula plus one sentence**Definitions**

- **Mode**: one allowed field pattern, labelled by the integers m, n = number of half-cycle variations across a and across b .
- **Dominant mode**: the mode with the **lowest cut-off frequency**.
 - Rectangular guide ($a > b$): **TE₁₀**, $f_c = c/2a$, $\lambda_c = 2a$.
 - Circular guide: **TE₁₁**, $f_c = 1.841 c/2\pi r$ (§4.3).
 - Between $f_{c,10}$ and the next cut-off only the dominant mode propagates → **single-mode operation**, the reason guides are sized this way.



E and H field of TE₁₀, TE₂₀, TE₀₁: one, two and one half-cycles across the walls.
Source: Gangaju, slide 20.

- **Degenerate modes: different field patterns with the same cut-off frequency.**
 - TE_{mn} and TM_{mn} for every $m, n \geq 1$: same f_c formula.
 - Square guide ($a = b$): TE_{10} and TE_{01} as well.
 - Circular guide: TE_{01} and TM_{11} (both root 3.832).
 - Unwanted, because power can couple between them at any discontinuity.



Cut-off ladder, Gangaju slide 22 (from Sadiku). The slide's caption says $a = 2.5$ cm, $b = 1$ cm; the arrows (TE_{10} at 3 GHz, TE_{20} at 6, TE_{50} and TE_{02} at 15) are those of a $5 \text{ cm} \times 2 \text{ cm}$ guide. TM arrows below the line sit on their TE twins: degeneracy.

verified/added

Prove that TM_{01} and TM_{10} modes do not exist 3

70 Ma

- TM: $H_z = 0$ and $E_z = E_0 \sin(m\pi x/a) \sin(n\pi y/b) e^{-\gamma z}$.
- $m = 0$ or $n = 0 \Rightarrow \sin 0 = 0 \Rightarrow E_z = 0$ everywhere.
- Every transverse component is a derivative of E_z (Step 1 with $H_z = 0$) $\Rightarrow E_x = E_y = H_x = H_y = 0$.
- All six components vanish $\Rightarrow$ **no field, no mode**. TM_{mn} needs $m \geq 1$ and $n \geq 1$.

Prove that the lowest cut-off TM mode is TM_{11} 3

82 Bh

- From above, TM needs $m, n \geq 1$.
- $f_c = \frac{c}{2} \sqrt{(m/a)^2 + (n/b)^2}$ grows with both m and n .
- Smallest admissible pair is $m = n = 1$: $f_{c, TM_{11}} = \frac{c}{2} \sqrt{\frac{1}{a^2} + \frac{1}{b^2}}$, for any a, b .

Show that the dominant TE mode is TE_{10} ; compare TE_{10} with TE_{20} 2 3

71 Bh, 81 Bh

- TE: $H_z = H_0 \cos \cos$ survives with one index zero ($\cos 0 = 1$); only TE_{00} is excluded (constant H_z , all transverse components zero).
- Two candidates for the lowest f_c : $f_{c,10} = \frac{c}{2a}$, $f_{c,01} = \frac{c}{2b}$.
- $a > b \Rightarrow f_{c,10} < f_{c,01} \Rightarrow$ **TE_{10} is dominant**. It also beats TM_{11} , since $\frac{1}{a^2} < \frac{1}{a^2} + \frac{1}{b^2}$.
- 81 Bh prints "when $b > a$ ". With $b > a$ it is TE_{01} that is dominant; TE_{10} needs $a > b$. The paper has the inequality reversed. Prove the $a > b$ case and state this.

verified/added

	TE_{10}	TE_{20}
f_c	$c/2a$	$c/a = 2f_{c,10}$
λ_c	$2a$	a
Variation across a	one half-cycle	two half-cycles
Field components	E_y, H_x, H_z only	same three
Status	dominant	higher-order

- Single-mode band: $c/2a < f < c/a$ provided $a \geq 2b$ (otherwise TE_{01} arrives first at $c/2b$).

Dominant vs degenerate modes; for $a = 3b$ find the dominant mode among $TM_{01}, TM_{10}, TM_{11}, TM_{21}, TM_{12}, TM_{02}, TM_{20}$ 2+2 3

72 Ma, 82 Ba · full working in the companion, Problem 4

- With $a = 3b$: $f_c = \frac{c}{2a} \sqrt{m^2 + 9n^2}$.
- $TM_{01}, TM_{10}, TM_{02}, TM_{20}$ **do not exist** (an index is zero).
- TM_{11} : $\sqrt{10} = 3.162$; TM_{21} : $\sqrt{13} = 3.606$; TM_{12} : $\sqrt{37} = 6.083$ (in units of $c/2a$).
- **Dominant among those listed: TM_{11}** . (Overall, TE_{10} at 1 unit.)

Cut-off checks: does the guide pass the signal? 1+1+2 3 5

70 Bh, 72 Ash, 80 Bh · worked in the companion, Problem 3

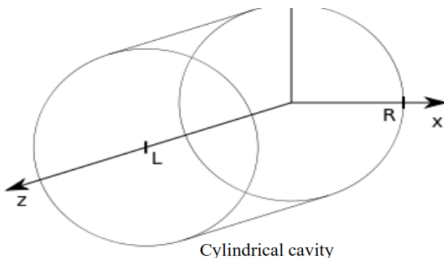
- Rule: compute f_c of the **dominant** mode; the signal propagates only if $f > f_c$.
- **70 Bh**: wall separation 5 cm, TE_{10} : $f_c = 3 \text{ GHz} > 1 \text{ GHz} \Rightarrow$ **1 GHz cannot propagate**; it decays at 59.2 Np/m.
- **80 Bh**: width 2.254 cm: $f_c = 6.65 \text{ GHz} > 6 \text{ GHz} \Rightarrow$ **6 GHz is not supported**.

4.3 Circular Waveguide**Field equations of a circular waveguide in TE / TM mode; TE vs TM; dominant mode** 7 8+2 10**HOT 4/24** 71 Ma, 75 Bh, 79 Bh, 82 Ba · the rectangular script in cylindrical co-ordinates**Set-up**

- Hollow circular pipe of inner radius a , co-ordinates (ρ, ϕ, z) , fields $\propto e^{-j\beta z}$; $k_c^2 = k^2 - \beta^2$, with $k = \omega\sqrt{\mu\epsilon}$.
- **Step 1**, the cylindrical version of the transverse equations (Waveguide.pdf p8, Pozar §3.4):

$$E_\rho = -\frac{j}{k_c^2} \left(\beta \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial \rho} + \frac{\omega\mu}{\rho} \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial \phi} \right), \quad E_\phi = -\frac{j}{k_c^2} \left(\frac{\beta}{\rho} \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial \phi} - \omega\mu \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial \rho} \right),$$

$$H_\rho = \frac{j}{k_c^2} \left(\frac{\omega\epsilon}{\rho} \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial \phi} - \beta \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial \rho} \right), \quad H_\phi = -\frac{j}{k_c^2} \left(\omega\epsilon \frac{\partial E_z}{\partial \rho} + \frac{\beta}{\rho} \frac{\partial H_z}{\partial \phi} \right).$$



Cylindrical co-ordinates. The figure is a circular cavity (a guide closed at both ends, §4.8); the guide itself is the same cylinder, open along z .

Source: Gangaju, slide 93.

TE_{nm}: $E_z = 0$

- $H_z = (A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi) J_n(k_c \rho) e^{-j\beta z}$.
- **Boundary**: $E_\phi(\rho = a) = 0$. Since $E_\phi \propto \partial H_z / \partial \rho$:
 $J'_n(k_c a) = 0 \Rightarrow \boxed{k_c = p'_{nm}/a}$, $p'_{nm} = m\text{-th root of } J'_n$.

$$E_\rho = \frac{-j\omega\mu n}{k_c^2 \rho} (A \cos n\phi - B \sin n\phi) J_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$E_\phi = \frac{j\omega\mu}{k_c} (A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi) J'_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$H_\rho = \frac{-j\beta}{k_c} (A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi) J'_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$H_\phi = \frac{-j\beta n}{k_c^2 \rho} (A \cos n\phi - B \sin n\phi) J_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$- f_c = \frac{p'_{nm}}{2\pi a \sqrt{\mu\epsilon}}, \quad Z_{TE} = \frac{E_\rho}{H_\phi} = \frac{\omega\mu}{\beta} = \frac{\eta k}{\beta}.$$

Step 2 and 3: separate the Helmholtz equation

- $\frac{\partial^2 h_z}{\partial \rho^2} + \frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial h_z}{\partial \rho} + \frac{1}{\rho^2} \frac{\partial^2 h_z}{\partial \phi^2} + k_c^2 h_z = 0$.
- $h_z = R(\rho)P(\phi)$:
 - $P'' + n^2 P = 0 \Rightarrow P = A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi$; n an integer because the field repeats every 2π .
 - $\rho^2 R'' + \rho R' + (k_c^2 \rho^2 - n^2) R = 0$: **Bessel's equation**
 $\Rightarrow R = C J_n(k_c \rho) + D Y_n(k_c \rho)$.
 - $Y_n \rightarrow \infty$ at $\rho = 0 \Rightarrow D = 0$.

TM_{nm}: $H_z = 0$

- $E_z = (A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi) J_n(k_c \rho) e^{-j\beta z}$.
- **Boundary**: $E_z(\rho = a) = 0$ directly:
 $J_n(k_c a) = 0 \Rightarrow \boxed{k_c = p_{nm}/a}$, $p_{nm} = m\text{-th root of } J_n$.

$$E_\rho = \frac{-j\beta}{k_c} (A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi) J'_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$E_\phi = \frac{-j\beta n}{k_c^2 \rho} (A \cos n\phi - B \sin n\phi) J_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$H_\rho = \frac{j\omega\epsilon n}{k_c^2 \rho} (A \cos n\phi - B \sin n\phi) J_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$H_\phi = \frac{-j\omega\epsilon}{k_c} (A \sin n\phi + B \cos n\phi) J'_n(k_c \rho)$$

$$- f_c = \frac{p_{nm}}{2\pi a \sqrt{\mu\epsilon}}, \quad Z_{TM} = \frac{E_\rho}{H_\phi} = \frac{\beta}{\omega\epsilon} = \frac{\eta\beta}{k}.$$

- **Sign**: Waveguide.pdf p11 prints E_ϕ with a +; it is -.
 wg.py fails the curl equation with the +. verified/added

Root table and mode order (all a circular answer needs)

Mode	Root	λ_c	Order
TE ₁₁	$p'_{11} = 1.841$	$3.41a$	1st, dominant
TM ₀₁	$p_{01} = 2.405$	$2.61a$	2nd, lowest TM
TE ₂₁	$p'_{21} = 3.054$	$2.06a$	3rd
TE ₀₁	$p'_{01} = 3.832$	$1.64a$	4th (low-loss mode)
TM ₁₁	$p_{11} = 3.832$	$1.64a$	degenerate with TE ₀₁

$\lambda_c = 2\pi a/p$. Roots from `scipy` in `wg.py`. Worked example: $a = 2$ cm gives TE₁₁ at 4.40 GHz and TM₀₁ at 5.74 GHz (Waveguide.pdf p13).

TE vs TM in a circular guide (71 Ma)

	TE _{nm}	TM _{nm}
Longitudinal	$E_z = 0, H_z \neq 0$	$H_z = 0, E_z \neq 0$
Boundary	$J'_n(k_c a) = 0$	$J_n(k_c a) = 0$
Roots	p'_{nm}	p_{nm}
Dominant	TE ₁₁ , 1.841	TM ₀₁ , 2.405
Impedance	$\eta k/\beta > \eta$	$\eta\beta/k < \eta$
$m = 0$?	TE _{n0} absent	TM _{n0} absent
Special	TE ₀₁ : loss falls with f	TM ₀₁ : symmetric, rotary joints

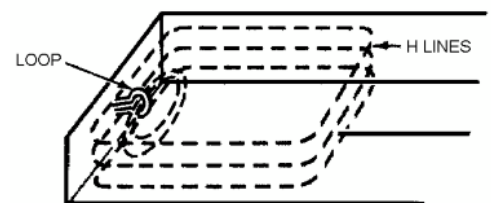
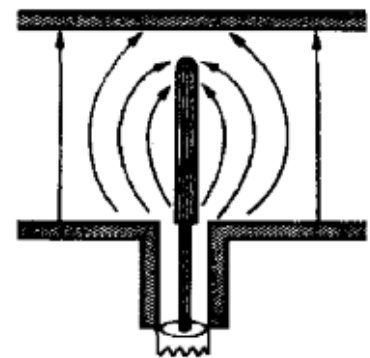
- **75 Bh:** dominant TE mode = TE₁₁, dominant TM mode = TM₀₁, and TE₁₁ is dominant overall since $1.841 < 2.405$.

4.4 Coupling Energy into a Waveguide: Probes, Loops and Slots

Probe coupling vs loop coupling 5

PIN 1/24 69 Bh · also the answer to "how is a cavity or klystron excited"

	Probe	Loop
Couples to	E field	H field
Acts as	quarter-wave monopole antenna	small magnetic dipole
Best position	centre of broad wall a , parallel to E lines, $\lambda_g/4$ from the shorted end (E maximum)	where H is strongest, e.g. at the shorted end; loop plane normal to H lines
Less coupling	shorten, move off centre, shield	rotate, or move to fewer H lines
Bandwidth	grows with probe diameter	grows with wire size
Power	door-knob probe: more area, more power	grows with loop diameter
Removal	same probe, reverse action	same loop, induced current



Probe (top) launches E lines; loop (bottom) links H lines.

Source: Gangaju, slides 3 and 6.

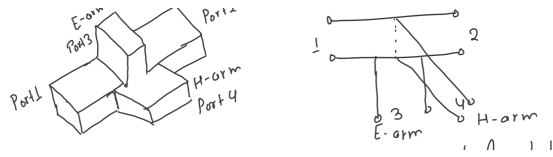
- **Slot / aperture:** a hole in the wall where the field is strong; gives **loose** coupling, used between a guide and a cavity or a second guide (directional coupler, §4.6).
- Choice depends on: voltage breakdown near an antinode, ease of adjustment, constancy of coupling under mechanical change, not disturbing an electron beam, matching.

4.5 Waveguide Tee Junctions and the Magic Tee

Explain the magic tee with a neat diagram and derive its S-matrix; E-plane vs H-plane tee 3+3 4 5 6

8

TOP 9/24 71 Ma, 71 Bh, 72 Ash, 72 Ma, 79 Ch, 79 Bh, 80 Ch, 80 Bh, 82 Bh · the matrices are catalogued in §3.6; this band adds construction, derivation and use



Magic tee: collinear ports 1, 2; E-arm 3; H-arm 4.

Construction

- A **hybrid** of the two simple tees on one junction:
 - **E-plane (series) tee**: side arm on the **broad** wall, its axis parallel to the main guide's E field. Port 3.
 - **H-plane (shunt) tee**: side arm on the **narrow** wall, in the plane of H. Port 4.
- Collinear arms 1 and 2 are symmetric about both side arms.
- A **post and iris** inside the junction match ports 3 and 4; without them the junction is simply a "hybrid tee" and is poorly matched.
- It is called **magic** because a matched 4-port with this symmetry turns out to be matched at **all** ports and isolates the two pairs, which nothing in its shape makes obvious.

Derivation of the S-matrix, the 4-mark version asked in 80 Bh and 72 Ma

- 4 ports $\Rightarrow$ a 4×4 matrix $[S]$; write all sixteen S_{ij} out, i, j from 1 to 4.
- H-arm symmetry**: input at 4 reaches 1 and 2 equally and **in phase** $\Rightarrow S_{14} = S_{24}$.
- E-arm antisymmetry**: input at 3 reaches 1 and 2 equally and in **antiphase** $\Rightarrow S_{13} = -S_{23}$.
- E and H arms are orthogonal**: an E-arm wave cannot excite the H-arm mode $\Rightarrow S_{34} = S_{43} = 0$.
- Matched side arms** (post and iris) $\Rightarrow S_{33} = S_{44} = 0$.
- Reciprocity** $\Rightarrow S_{ij} = S_{ji}$.
- Unitary, column 3**: $|S_{13}|^2 + |S_{23}|^2 = 1$, with $|S_{13}| = |S_{23}| \Rightarrow S_{13} = 1/\sqrt{2}$. Same for column 4: $S_{14} = 1/\sqrt{2}$.
- Unitary, column 1**: $|S_{11}|^2 + |S_{12}|^2 + \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1 \Rightarrow S_{11} = S_{12} = 0$; column 2 gives $S_{22} = 0$.
- Result: $[S] = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$, matched at all four ports, lossless, reciprocal.

Properties (read straight off the matrix)

- Into **H-arm** (4): equal halves at 1 and 2, **in phase**; nothing at 3.
- Into **E-arm** (3): equal halves at 1 and 2, **antiphase**; nothing at 4.
- Into **collinear** port 1: halves at 3 and 4; **nothing** at 2.
- Equal in-phase signals at 1 and 2: **sum** emerges at 4, nothing at 3.
- Equal antiphase signals at 1 and 2: **difference** emerges at 3, nothing at 4.
- All four ports matched: no reflection anywhere.

Applications

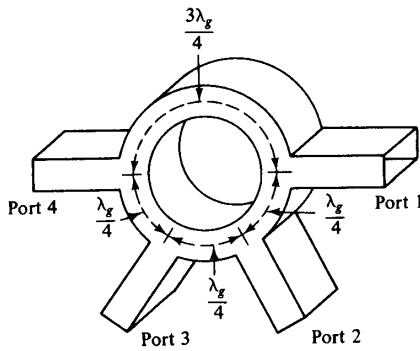
- Power combiner, e.g. two radar transmitters into one antenna (§3.8).
- Duplexer: transmitter and receiver on the isolated E and H arms (§3.6).
- Balanced mixer: signal on one side arm, local oscillator on the other.
- Impedance bridge / measurement: unknown and standard on 1 and 2, null detector on 3.
- Monopulse radar comparator: sum and difference channels.

E-plane tee vs H-plane tee

	E-plane (series)	H-plane (shunt)
Side arm on	broad wall, $\parallel$ E	narrow wall, $\parallel$ H
Side-arm input	antiphase at 1, 2	in phase at 1, 2
Relation	$S_{13} = -S_{23}$	$S_{13} = S_{23}$
Equivalent	series junction	shunt junction
In-phase at 1, 2	cancel in side arm	add in side arm
Matrix	§3.6, $-1/\sqrt{2}$ in row 3	§3.6, $-1/2$ at S_{12}

- Both are 3-ports and **cannot** be lossless, reciprocal and matched at once (§3.5): ports 1 and 2 stay mismatched with $|S_{11}| = 1/2$.

69 Bh 5, 80 Ba 4



Hybrid ring (rat race)

- Annular line, circumference $1.5\lambda_g$, four arms at $\lambda_g/4$, $\lambda_g/4$, $\lambda_g/4$ and $3\lambda_g/4$.
- Into port 1: the two ways round to port 3 differ by $\lambda_g/2$ (180°) $\rightarrow$ cancel; to 2 and 4 they add. Same behaviour as a magic tee, in planar form, but only at the design frequency.

Tee combinations: arms terminated, two tees joined, a 3-port coupler 4 4+4+2 5 8 10

HOT 5/24 70 Ma, 75 Bh, 77 Ch, 78 Ch, 82 Ba · each solved by connecting or terminating ports in `wg.py`; full working in the companion, Problems 6 to 8

- **Hybrid tee with a terminated arm** (82 Ba, 70 Ma): a matched load simply deletes that row and column.
 - E-arm terminated $\Rightarrow$ a matched, reciprocal **in-phase divider** from the H-arm; collinear ports isolated; lossy only when driven from a collinear arm (half goes to the load).
 - H-arm terminated $\Rightarrow$ the same but **antiphase** from the E-arm.
 - Both collinear arms terminated $\Rightarrow [S] = [0]$: E and H arms matched and completely isolated.
 - For **shorted** arms (82 Bh) see §3.6: $[S] = -[I]$.
- **Two magic tees joined E-arm to E-arm** (77 Ch): a matched, lossless, reciprocal 6-port. The **difference** signal of one tee crosses to the other and re-appears in antiphase; the **sum** signal stays in its own H-arm. Joined H to H (78 Ch), the roles swap.
- **3-port directional coupler** (75 Bh): the 4-port coupler with its isolated port loaded inside the casing. Matched and reciprocal, so by §3.5 it **must** be lossy, and it is: power driven backwards into the through port loses its coupled share in the internal load.

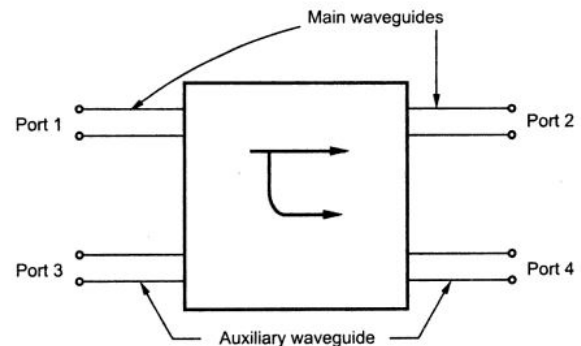
4.6 Directional Couplers

Explain directional couplers and the four parameters used to describe their performance 4 5 6

HOT 3/24 73 Bh, 79 Ch, 80 Ba

What it is

- A **4-port** junction that samples power travelling in **one direction** only.
- Main guide: port 1 (input) to port 2 (through).
- Auxiliary guide: port 4 (coupled) and port 3 (isolated), Gangaju's numbering.
- Ideal, all ports matched:
 - $1 \rightarrow 2$ passes almost all the power.
 - $1 \rightarrow 4$ a known small fraction.
 - $1 \rightarrow 3$ nothing.
- Uses: **power monitoring**, **reflectometers** and **VSWR** measurement (one coupler each way), network analysers, signal injection, and as a 3 dB hybrid.
- S-matrix: §3.6. Note §3.6 labels the coupled port 3; the numbering varies by text, the physics does not.



Block view, Gangaju slide 54.

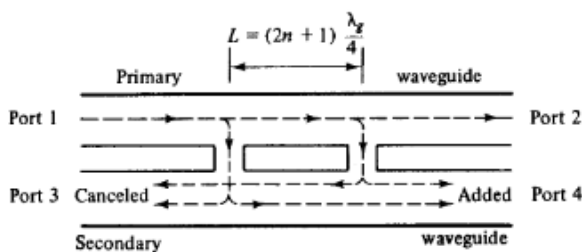
The four parameters (P_i = power at port i , input at 1)

Parameter	Definition	Measures
Coupling C	$10 \log \frac{P_1}{P_4}$ dB	how much is sampled
Directivity D	$10 \log \frac{P_4}{P_3}$ dB	forward vs backward discrimination
Isolation I	$10 \log \frac{P_1}{P_3}$ dB	leakage to isolated port
Insertion loss	$10 \log \frac{P_1}{P_2}$ dB	loss on the main line

- $I = C + D$. Example: $P_1 = 10$ mW, $P_4 = 1$ mW, $P_3 = 0.1$ μ W $\Rightarrow C = 10$ dB, $D = 40$ dB, $I = 50$ dB.
- Good coupler: D of 30 to 40 dB, VSWR near 1.

Two-hole coupler: why it is directional

- Two small holes in the common wall, spaced $d = (2n + 1)\lambda_g/4$.
- Each hole radiates a small wave into the auxiliary guide, both ways.
- **Forward** waves (towards port 4) travel equal total paths $\rightarrow$ **in phase** $\rightarrow$ add.
- **Backward** waves (towards port 3) differ by $2d = (2n + 1)\lambda_g/2 \rightarrow (2n + 1)\pi$ out of phase $\rightarrow$ **cancel**.
- Exact only at one frequency; more holes with tapered sizes widen the band.



Two-hole coupler, Gangaju slide 57.

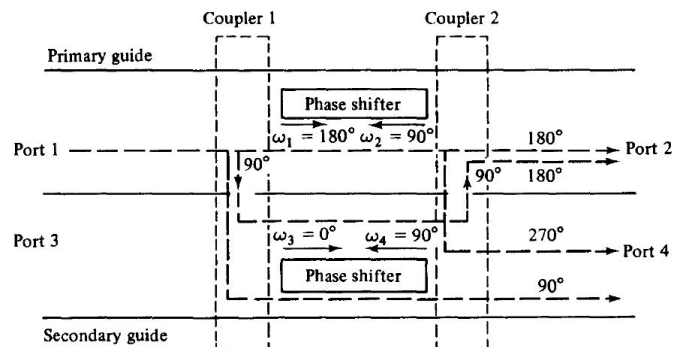
4.7 Ferrite Devices: Circulators, Isolators, Phase Shifters

Explain the microwave circulator 5

HOT 3/24 70 Bh, 72 Ash, 73 Ma · asked word for word each time

Circulator

- A **non-reciprocal** multi-port in which power entering port n leaves only by port $n + 1$: $1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1$ (3-port), or round four ports.
- Ideal: **matched** at every port and **lossless**, but $S_{ij} \neq S_{ji}$.
3-port form (matrix of §3.5): $[S] = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$.
- Non-reciprocity comes from a **magnetised ferrite**.
- **Faraday rotation**: a plane wave along a ferrite rod in an axial magnetic field has its polarisation rotated by an angle set by the field strength and the rod length, and in the **same absolute sense** whichever way it travels. A return trip therefore doubles the rotation instead of undoing it.
- **Four-port construction** (slide 62): two 3 dB side-hole couplers, a primary and a secondary guide, and a non-reciprocal ferrite phase shifter in each.
 - Port 1 $\rightarrow$ port 2: both paths arrive with the same phase $\rightarrow$ add.
 - Port 1 $\rightarrow$ port 4: the paths differ by $180^\circ \rightarrow$ cancel.
 - The phase shifters behave differently in the reverse direction, so port 2 feeds port 3, port 3 feeds 4, port 4 feeds 1.



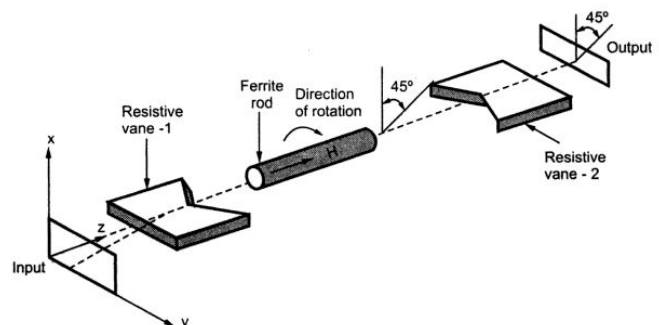
Four-port circulator: two 3 dB couplers plus ferrite phase shifters. Gangaju slide 62.

Applications

- **Duplexer**: transmitter port 1, antenna 2, receiver 3 (§3.6).
- Reflection amplifiers (tunnel diode, parametric): separate input from output.
- An **isolator**, by loading one port.

Isolator (uniline)

- Passes power one way, **absorbs** it the other way: $[S] = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$.
- Circulator with port 3 matched-terminated, or a Faraday-rotation isolator:
 - Input E vertical; ferrite rotates it 45° ; output guide twisted 45° to accept it.
 - Reflection from the load is rotated a further 45° in the same sense $\rightarrow 90^\circ$ from the input orientation $\rightarrow$ absorbed by a resistive vane.
- Use: between a klystron or magnetron and its load, so a mismatch cannot reflect back and pull the oscillator frequency.



Phase shifter (syllabus, not yet asked)

- Changes the phase of the transmitted wave by $\Delta\phi = 2\pi l/\lambda_g$, either by changing the **length** l or the **guide wavelength** λ_g .
- Mechanical: telescoping coaxial line; **dielectric vane** moved across the guide (more dielectric in the high-E centre, smaller λ_g , more phase).
- Electrical: **ferrite** under a variable bias field; PIN-diode switched lines.
- Uses: phased-array beam steering, phase discriminators, power-amplifier linearisation.

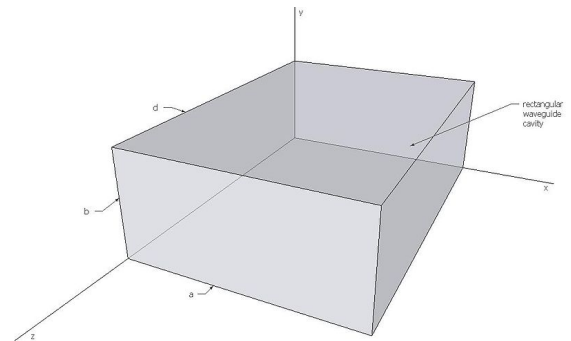
4.8 Cavity Resonators

Explain microwave cavity resonators 4 6

PIN 2/24 74 Ma, 74 Bh

What and why

- A closed metal enclosure that stores EM energy at discrete resonant frequencies: a section of waveguide shorted at **both** ends.
- Microwave replacement for the LC tank: lumped L and C fail above a few hundred MHz (radiation, skin effect, lead parasitics).
- Circuit analogue: stored E energy $\rightarrow$ C, stored H energy $\rightarrow$ L, wall loss $\rightarrow$ R.
- Types: **rectangular**, **circular**, **re-entrant** (the klystron cavity, Ch 5).
- Infinitely many modes; the lowest is the **dominant** mode.



Rectangular cavity $a \times b \times d$. Gangaju slide 90.

Rectangular cavity: resonant frequency

- Standing wave along z : the guide length must hold p half guide-wavelengths, $d = p\lambda_g/2 \Rightarrow \beta = p\pi/d$.
- $k^2 = k_c^2 + \beta^2$ gives

$$f_{mnp} = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{\mu\epsilon}} \sqrt{\left(\frac{m}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{n}{b}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{p}{d}\right)^2}$$

- Allowed indices:
 - TE_{mnp}: $p \geq 1$, m and n not both zero.
 - TM_{mnp}: $m, n \geq 1$, $p \geq 0$.
- Dominant for $b < a < d$: **TE₁₀₁**, $f_{101} = \frac{c}{2} \sqrt{\frac{1}{a^2} + \frac{1}{d^2}}$.
Example $2 \times 1 \times 3$ cm: 9.01 GHz, next TE₁₀₂ at 12.5 GHz.
- Circular cavity, radius a , length d :

$$f = \frac{c}{2\pi} \sqrt{\left(\frac{p'_{nm}}{a}\right)^2 + \left(\frac{l\pi}{d}\right)^2} \text{ (TE), with } p_{nm} \text{ for TM.}$$

Quality factor

- $Q = \omega \frac{\text{energy stored}}{\text{power lost}}$.
- Cavities reach 10^4 to 10^6 ; a lumped LC circuit about 10^2 .
- Losses add as reciprocals:

$$\frac{1}{Q_L} = \frac{1}{Q_c} + \frac{1}{Q_d} + \frac{1}{Q_{ext}}$$

- Q_c : wall conduction loss.
- $Q_d = 1/\tan \delta$: dielectric filling.
- Q_{ext} : power taken by the coupling; Q_L is the loaded Q.
- Coupling (probe, loop, aperture) is **under-, critically or over-coupled**; at critical coupling the input is matched.

Applications

- Klystron and magnetron cavities; wavemeters; filters; oscillator stabilisation; TR cells in duplexers.

4.9 Solid-State and Quantum Devices: Gunn Diode, MASER, Microwave Transistors

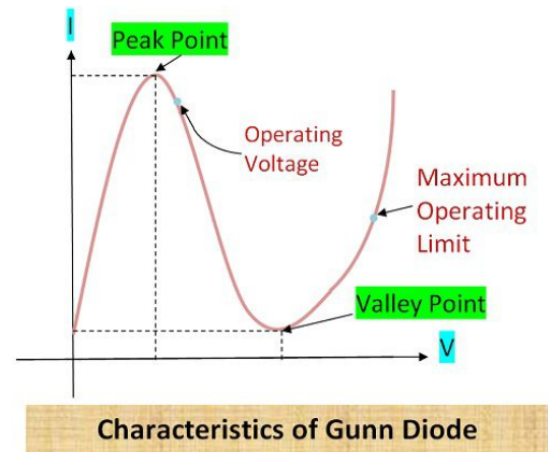
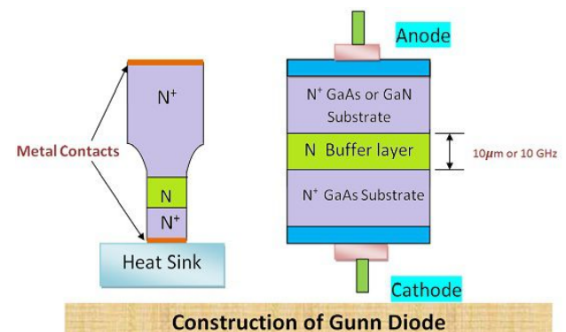
Gunn diode 4

PIN 1/24 79 Bh · short note

- **Transferred-electron device (TED):** bulk n-type GaAs (or InP), **no p-n junction**; “diode” only because it has two terminals.
- **Construction:** n^+ contact / lightly doped n active layer (epitaxial, about 6 to 18 μm) / n^+ substrate, metal contacts, heat sink.
- **Two-valley model** (Ridley-Watkins-Hilsum):
 - GaAs conduction band has a **lower valley** (light electrons, high mobility) and an **upper satellite valley** about 0.36 eV higher (heavy, low mobility).
 - Low field: electrons stay in the lower valley, current rises with voltage.
 - Above a threshold field (about 3.2 kV/cm) electrons gain enough energy to **transfer** to the upper valley → average mobility falls → drift velocity **falls as field rises**.
 - That is **negative differential resistance** between the peak and the valley of the I-V curve.
- **Oscillation:** a high-field **domain** forms at the cathode, drifts to the anode at $v_d \approx 10^5$ m/s, and a new one forms when it arrives:

$$f = \frac{v_d}{L} \quad \text{e.g.} \quad \frac{10^5}{10 \mu\text{m}} = 10 \text{ GHz}$$

- **Correction to the deck** (slide 72): it says the low-field current rises because electrons move from the valence band to the conduction band. It does not; the carriers are already conduction electrons in the lower valley. verified/added



Construction and the peak-valley characteristic. Gangaju slides 69 and 73.

(+) and (-)

- (+) small, cheap, low noise, wide band, reliable, 1 to 100+ GHz.
- (-) low efficiency (a few %), poor temperature stability, high bias current.

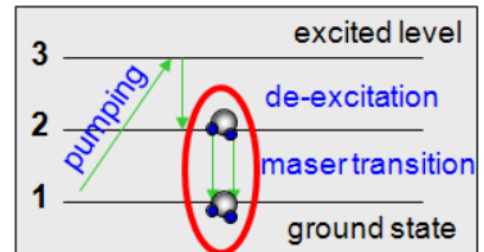
Applications

- Local oscillators, police and door-opening radar sensors, low-power transmitters, microwave relay links.

MASER 4

PIN 1/24 80 Ba · short note

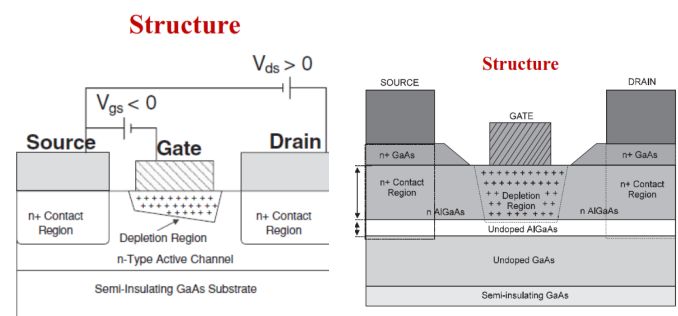
- **Microwave Amplification by Stimulated Emission of Radiation:** the microwave ancestor of the laser (Townes, 1954).
- A **quantum** device working on energy levels of atoms or molecules. The deck's "semiconductor device" is wrong. verified/added
- **Three-level principle:**
 - **Pump** at f_{13} lifts particles from level 1 to 3.
 - They decay without radiating to the **metastable** level 2 and accumulate → **population inversion** between 2 and 1.
 - An incoming signal at $f_{21} = (E_2 - E_1)/h$ **stimulates** emission of identical photons (same frequency, phase, direction) → coherent **amplification**.
- **Types:** ammonia gas maser (23.87 GHz, the first), hydrogen maser (1.42 GHz, frequency standard), solid-state ruby maser (Cr^{3+} in Al_2O_3 , tuned by a magnetic field, cooled to a few kelvin).
- **Key property:** extremely **low noise**.
- **Applications:** radio-telescope and deep-space receivers, satellite ground stations, atomic clocks.



Pump to level 3, relax to 2, stimulated transition 2 to 1.
Gangaju slide 78.

Microwave transistors (syllabus, not yet asked)

- Differ from low-frequency parts in **geometry** and **packaging**: interdigitated, overlay and matrix layouts cut lead inductance and junction capacitance.
- **Si BJT**: up to a few GHz. **HBT** (heterojunction, e.g. SiGe, InGaP/GaAs): higher f_T , amplifiers and MMICs.
- **GaAs MESFET**: Schottky-barrier gate on an n-channel; high electron mobility → well above 5 GHz; low noise, depletion-mode.
- **HEMT**: AlGaAs/GaAs heterojunction confines a 2-D electron gas in undoped GaAs, away from donor scattering → even higher mobility, beyond 20 GHz, lowest noise.



MESFET (left) and HEMT (right) cross-sections. Gangaju slides 85 and 86.

4.10 Attenuators, Terminations, Windows, Microstrip

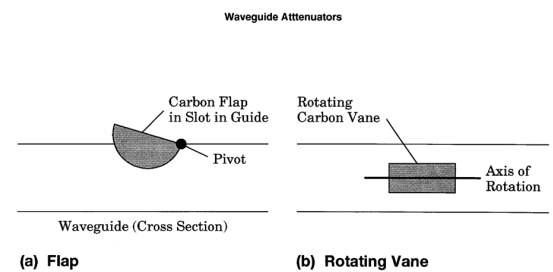
Microstrips 5

PIN 1/24 69 Bh · geometry and microstrip vs strip-line are in §1.6; stub realisation in §2.9

- Strip of width W on a substrate of thickness h and permittivity ϵ_r , ground plane underneath, air above.
- **Quasi-TEM**: the field lives partly in air and partly in the substrate, so it sees an effective permittivity $\epsilon_{\text{eff}} = \frac{\epsilon_r + 1}{2} + \frac{\epsilon_r - 1}{2} \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 + 12h/W}}$, $1 < \epsilon_{\text{eff}} < \epsilon_r$.
- $v_p = c/\sqrt{\epsilon_{\text{eff}}}$, $\lambda_g = \lambda_0/\sqrt{\epsilon_{\text{eff}}}$; Z_0 falls as W/h rises.
- (+) planar, cheap photolithography, components mount on top, MMIC friendly.
- (-) radiation at bends, dispersion, lower Q and power than waveguide, crosstalk.

Attenuators and terminations (syllabus, not yet asked)

- **Attenuator:** reduces power by a set amount with low VSWR; a resistive (carbon) vane or flap in the guide absorbs power through induced currents.
 - **Fixed:** lossy vane, or lossy walls.
 - **Variable:** **flap** lowered through a slot in the centre of the broad wall (deeper = more loss, since E is strongest there), **vane** moved from side wall to centre, or **rotary** vane in a circular guide.
- **Matched termination:** absorbs all incident power; a guide section ending in a **tapered** absorbing wedge so the impedance changes gradually and nothing reflects.
- Reference **short:** a metal plate; **sliding short:** movable, sets a reactance.



Flap and rotating-vane attenuators. Gangaju slide 39.

Windows, posts and screws (waveguide matching)

- **Inductive window:** diaphragms from the side walls → shunt L .
- **Capacitive window:** from top and bottom → shunt C ; limits power (breakdown).
- **Resonant window:** both → parallel LC , transparent at resonance.
- **Post / screw:** part-way in → capacitive; right through → inductive; $\lambda/4$ deep → series resonance.
- Waveguide equivalent of a stub (§2.6).

4.11 PYQ Mapping

Theory questions, covered in this document

- Rectangular waveguide field equations, TE mode → §4.1. 70 Bh 7, 74 Ma 4, 77 Ch 8, 79 Ch 10, 80 Ch 10, 80 Bh 4
- Rectangular waveguide field equations, TM mode → §4.1. **Most repeated topic of the chapter, with the TE list: 14 papers.** 70 Ma 7, 71 Bh 8, 72 Ma 5, 74 Bh 10, 76 Bh 10, 81 Ba 8, 81 Bh 8
- Rectangular waveguide: modes of propagation and critical parameters → §4.1 Step 6 and §4.2. 69 Bh 8
- Prove TM_{01} / TM_{10} do not exist → §4.2. 70 Ma 3
- Lowest TM mode is TM_{11} → §4.2. 82 Bh 3
- TE_{10} dominant; TE_{10} vs TE_{20} → §4.2, with the 81 Bh inequality defect. 71 Bh 2, 81 Bh 3
- Dominant and degenerate modes; $a = 3b$ → §4.2 and companion Problem 4. 72 Ash 5, 72 Ma 2+2, 82 Ba 3
- Circular waveguide, TE / TM field equations, TE vs TM, dominant mode → §4.3. 71 Ma 10, 75 Bh 8+2, 79 Bh 10, 82 Ba 7
- Probe vs loop coupling → §4.4. 69 Bh 5
- Magic tee: principle, S-parameters, derivation → §4.5 and §3.6. 71 Ma 5, 71 Bh 5, 72 Ash 3+3, 72 Ma 6, 79 Ch 5, 79 Bh 4, 80 Ch 5, 80 Bh 4
- Magic tee with both arms shorted → §3.6. 82 Bh 4
- E-plane vs H-plane tee → §4.5. 69 Bh 5, 80 Ba 4
- Hybrid tee; terminated E, H, co-planar arms → §4.5 and companion Problem 7. 70 Ma 8, 82 Ba 4+4+2
- Two magic tees joined at E-arms / in H-plane → §4.5 and companion Problems 6 and 8. 77 Ch 10, 78 Ch 5
- 3-port directional coupler, S-parameter analysis → §4.5, §3.5. 75 Bh 4
- Directional couplers; four performance parameters → §4.6. 73 Bh 6, 79 Ch 5, 80 Ba 4
- Circulators → §4.7. 70 Bh 5, 72 Ash 5, 73 Ma 5
- Cavity resonators → §4.8. 74 Ma 4, 74 Bh 6
- Gunn diode → §4.9. 79 Bh 4
- MASER → §4.9. 80 Ba 4
- Microstrips → §4.10 and §1.6. 69 Bh 5

Numerical content

- This chapter has a numerical companion, Ch4 - RF Microwave Components and Devices - Numerical Problems and Solutions: rectangular-guide parameters (80 Ba, 77 Ch), cut-off checks (70 Bh, 80 Bh), mode ranking (72 Ma), circular-guide cut-offs (75 Bh), and the junction problems (77 Ch, 78 Ch, 82 Ba).

Syllabus topics never asked in 24 papers

- Termination, phase shifter, attenuators, microwave transistor. Each has a short band above (§4.7, §4.9, §4.10) sized for a 4-mark short note.

Errors in the sources, corrected here

- Deck slide 18: $k_y = n\pi/a$ should be $n\pi/b$.
- Deck slide 22: figure caption gives the wrong guide size (it is $5\text{ cm} \times 2\text{ cm}$).
- Deck slide 72: Gunn low-field current is not a valence-to-conduction transition.
- Deck slide 77: a MASER is a quantum device, not a semiconductor device.
- Waveguide.pdf p11: TM E_ϕ has a minus sign.
- Paper 81 Bh Q3a: TE₁₀ is dominant when $a > b$, not $b > a$.

Abbreviations used in these notes

Only these are ever shortened. Anything not on this list is written out in full.

Short	Means	Short	Means
RF	radio frequency	MW, M/W	microwave
EM, EMR	electromagnetic (radiation)	TEM	transverse electromagnetic mode
TE	transverse electric mode	TM	transverse magnetic mode
WG	waveguide	TL	transmission line
VSWR	voltage standing wave ratio	SWR	standing wave ratio
VNA	vector network analyzer	SA	spectrum analyzer
DUT	device under test	S-params	scattering parameters
RL	return loss	IL	insertion loss
ML	mismatch loss	NF	noise figure
BW	bandwidth	SNR	signal to noise ratio
Tx, TX	transmitter	Rx, RX	receiver
BTS	base transceiver station	GSM	global system for mobile communications
EIRP	effective isotropic radiated power	ERP	effective radiated power
SAR	specific absorption rate	SARPs	standards and recommended practices
HERP	hazards of EM radiation to personnel	RADAR	radio detection and ranging
ASR	airport surveillance radar	CW	continuous wave
Short	Means	Short	Means
TWT, TWTA	traveling wave tube (amplifier)	BWO	backward wave oscillator
CFA	cross-field amplifier	LNA	low noise amplifier
HPA	high power amplifier	SWS	slow wave structure
O-type	linear beam tube (axial B -field)	M-type	crossed-field tube ($E \perp B$)
MASER	microwave amplification by stimulated emission of radiation	LASER	light amplification by stimulated emission of radiation
MESFET	metal-semiconductor FET	HEMT	high electron mobility transistor
GaAs	gallium arsenide	FET	field effect transistor
BJT	bipolar junction transistor	PIN	p-type, intrinsic, n-type diode
IMPATT	impact ionization avalanche transit-time	TRAPATT	trapped plasma avalanche triggered transit
LPF	low pass filter	HPF	high pass filter
BPF	band pass filter	BSF	band stop filter
MAG	maximum available gain	MSG	maximum stable gain
MIC	microwave integrated circuit	MMIC	monolithic microwave integrated circuit
ADS	advanced design system	IF	intermediate frequency
LO	local oscillator	RFIC	radio frequency integrated circuit
PCB	printed circuit board	SMA	subminiature version A connector

Short	Means	Short	Means
attr(s)	attribute(s)	no.	number
freq	frequency	info	information
ops	operations	config	configuration
rm	remove	vs, Vs	versus
w/, w/o	with, without	Eg	example / for example
+Fig	draw a figure	(I)	importance / need / significance
→	leads to / therefore	+	and
=	is / equals	norm	normalized
max, min	maximum, minimum	calc	calculation / calculate
eq, eqn	equation	approx	approximately
pts	points	coeff	coefficient
temp	temperature	params	parameters

Standard and component terms (proper names and symbols, kept as standard): **Magic Tee** 180° hybrid junction (E-plane & H-plane tee combined) · **Directional Coupler** 4-port forward/reverse coupled wave device · **Circulator** non-reciprocal multi-port ferrite device ($1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 1$) · **Gunn Diode** transferred electron device (GaAs / InP, negative resistance) · **Bolometer** power detector (barretter: PTC, thermistor: NTC) · **Calorimeter** power measurement via heat transfer (static, circulating, dry, flow).

Key mathematical symbols: Z_0 characteristic impedance · Y_0 characteristic admittance · Γ reflection coefficient · S scattering matrix · K Rollett's stability factor · Δ determinant of S-matrix · μ single parameter stability metric · G_T transducer gain · G_{TU} unilateral transducer gain · f_c cutoff frequency · λ_g guide wavelength · v_p phase velocity · v_g group velocity.

Exam-paper month codes (used in the year tags): Ba = Baishakh · Bh = Bhadra · Ash = Ashwin · Ma = Magh · Ch = Chaitra.

Bold year tags are Regular exams, plain are Back exams.

Monospace year tags are BEI (EX 716, IV/I); normal font tags are BEX (EX 752 / EG 785EX, IV/II).

Tier chips over 24 papers, 2069–2082 BS: **TOP /24** = topic asked in 7 or more papers · **HOT /24** = 3 to 6 papers · **PIN /24** = 1 or 2 papers but worth ≥ 6 marks.

Mark chips such as **2+5** are the marks that question actually carried. **syllabus, no PYQ yet** marks a syllabus topic that has never been examined but is written up anyway. **verified/added** marks anything researched and added that was not in the source notes.